

LINAN YAO

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EDUCATION

Columbia University, New York

Ph.D., Political Science (2023)

Subfield: Major in Comparative Politics, Minor in American Politics

Dissertation Title: Popular Propaganda in Pop Culture: How China Sells Its Ideology

Advisors: Donald Green, Andrew Nathan, John Marshall

M.Phil., Political Science (2020)

M.A., Political Science (2017)

Yale University, New Haven

M.A., East Asian Studies (2015)

Peking University, Beijing

B.A., International Relations and Economics (2014)

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Vanderbilt University, Nashville

2023 - Present

Postdoctoral Researcher, Political Science Department

WZB Berlin Social Science Center, Berlin

Spring 2021

Visiting researcher, Institutions and Political Inequality Unit

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Robert S. Erikson, Karl Sigman, and Linan Yao. Electoral college bias and the 2020 presidential election. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 2020

WORKING PAPER

Papers in Submission

Selling Ideology: How China Engages Cultural Elites to Popularize Propaganda Films (Revise and Resubmit)

Entertainment as Trojan Horse: Voluntary Consumption of Propaganda in China, with Hanzhang Liu

Manuscripts in Preparation

Popular Entertainment as Propaganda: Insights from an Online Field Experiment in China
Soft Power or Just a Show? Reassessing China's Soft Power Deficit through the Rise of Cddrama in Southeast Asia, with Norashiqin Toh

Minimal Effects for Autocrats? A Meta-Analysis of the Persuasive Power of Authoritarian

Propaganda, with Georgiy Syunyaev

Propaganda Overload: Algorithmic Targeting on Chinese Digital Platforms, with Naijia Liu

GRANT & AWARDS

2023, CELSS Dissertation Grant, Columbia Experimental Laboratory for the Social Sciences

2022, Weatherhead Summer Grant, The Weatherhead East Asian Institute at Columbia University

2022, Kathryn and Shelby Cullom Davis International Fellowship, Columbia University

2022, CELSS Seed Grant, Columbia Experimental Laboratory for the Social Sciences

2021, Dissertation Fellowship, Political Science Department at Columbia University

2021, Weatherhead Summer Grant, The Weatherhead East Asian Institute at Columbia University

2020, Weatherhead Summer Grant, The Weatherhead East Asian Institute at Columbia University

2020, Dissertation Development Grant, Political Science Department at Columbia University

2017, Dean's Fellowship, Political Science Department at Columbia University

2014, The Edison Dick Fellowship, Yale University

2012, Guanghua Scholarship for Academic Excellence, Peking University

2011, Hong Kong Engineering Scholarship, Peking University

2010, Peking University Scholarship for Outstanding Freshman, Peking University

TEACHING

Vanderbilt University (Instructor)

Chinese Political System Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024

Columbia University (Teaching Fellow)

Experimental Research Spring 2023, Spring 2019

Voting and American Politics Fall 2022

Game Theory Spring 2018

Introduction to Human Rights Fall 2018, Fall 2017

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND INVITED TALKS

2024 American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Conference
Visions in Methodology Conference 2024
Southern Workshop in Empirical Political Science (SoWEPS-5)
Perspective Asia Lecture Series at Lund University (Invited Talk)

2023	Conference on Authoritarian Propaganda and Media Control Chinese Politics Research in Progress American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Conference Special Issue Workshop on Chinese Propaganda and Public Discourse Frontiers in Empirical Research on East Asia (FEREA) 2023 The Association for Asian Studies (AAS) Annual Conference 2023 2023 Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference
2022	Southern Political Science Association (SPSA) Annual Conference UCSD Young Scholars Conference USC 2nd China Research Group Doctoral Symposium
2021	American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Conference
2019	Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference
2018	Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference

POLICY EXPERIENCE

Ministry of Finance of the People's Republic of China, Beijing	Summer 2013
IBM consulting, Beijing	Summer 2012
China Beijing International Mining Exchange, Beijing	Summer 2011

ADDITIONAL ACADEMIC TRAINING

University of California, Los Angeles Research assistant for Professor James Tong	Spring 2016
ICPSR Summer School, Ann Arbor Student	Summer 2015
National Taiwan University, Taipei Exchange student	Fall 2013

COMMUNITY SERVICES

Columbia Food Pantry, New York	March 2020 - current
Columbia Students of Color Alliance E-board, New York	September 2018 - June 2019
Common Language (LGBT non-profit), Beijing	February 2013 - June 2013

SKILLS

Programming	R, Python, MySQL
Packages	Scrapy, Jieba, Word2vec, Scikit-Learn, TensorFlow, GGPlot2
Languages	Chinese (native), English